

The Marina is finally in the Port of Kotka approach channel. It is time to call up Kotka VTS.

It has been an eventful voyage - hearing a distress call in the Bay of Biscay, an injured crew member on board the Marina requiring helicopter assistance and then, on top of everything else, a power blackout and an encounter with the Finnish Coast Guard.

A few hectic days in the Port of Kotka lie ahead. As always they will involve discharging the cargo, dealing with port bureaucracy and then taking on another load. Kotka, situated next to the Helsinki region but still in the heartland of the Finnish wood-processing industry and immediately next to Russia with excellent road, rail and deep-sea connections, is an important port in Finland.

Captain James is looking forward to seeing some of his Finnish friends from the port. Perhaps there will be time for an evening visit to their cottage, and a hot sauna with a refreshing dip in the cold sea water? The Captain smiles at the thought.

And then a new voyage will begin - it is a seaman's life. And who knows what will happen during the next voyage...